

Linux Package Manager

Command Reference Guide

apt • rpm • yum

This reference guide covers the 10 most essential commands for three of the most widely used Linux package managers: APT (used on Debian/Ubuntu), RPM (Red Hat Package Manager), and YUM (Yellowdog Updater Modified). Each command includes its syntax and a brief description.

APT — Advanced Package Tool

Used on Debian, Ubuntu, and related distributions

01. **apt update**
Refreshes the local package index from all configured sources.
02. **apt upgrade**
Upgrades all installed packages to their latest available versions.
03. **apt install <package>**
Installs the specified package and its dependencies.
04. **apt remove <package>**
Removes the specified package but keeps its configuration files.
05. **apt purge <package>**
Removes the package along with all its configuration files.
06. **apt autoremove**
Removes packages that were installed as dependencies but are no longer needed.
07. **apt search <keyword>**
Searches the package repository for packages matching the keyword.
08. **apt show <package>**
Displays detailed information about a specific package.
09. **apt list --installed**
Lists all packages currently installed on the system.
10. **apt-cache depends <package>**
Shows the dependency tree for the specified package.

RPM — Red Hat Package Manager

Low-level package tool used on Red Hat, CentOS, Fedora, and SUSE

01. **rpm -ivh <package.rpm>**
Installs an RPM package with verbose output and a progress hash bar.
02. **rpm -Uvh <package.rpm>**
Upgrades an existing package or installs it if not already present.
03. **rpm -e <package>**
Erases (uninstalls) the specified package from the system.

04. **rpm -qa**

Queries and lists all packages currently installed on the system.

05. **rpm -qi <package>**

Displays detailed information about an installed package.

06. **rpm -ql <package>**

Lists all files installed by the specified package.

07. **rpm -qf <file_path>**

Identifies which package owns a given file on the system.

08. **rpm -qd <package>**

Lists only the documentation files installed by a package.

09. **rpm --verify <package>**

Verifies the integrity of installed package files against the RPM database.

10. **rpm -qpR <package.rpm>**

Lists the dependencies required by an RPM file before installation.

YUM — Yellowdog Updater Modified

Higher-level package manager for RPM-based systems (CentOS, RHEL, Fedora)

01. **yum install <package>**

Installs the specified package along with all required dependencies.

02. **yum update**

Updates all installed packages to their latest available versions.

03. **yum remove <package>**

Removes the specified package and its dependent packages.

04. **yum search <keyword>**

Searches package repositories for packages matching the keyword.

05. **yum info <package>**

Displays detailed metadata and information about a specific package.

06. **yum list installed**

Lists all packages currently installed on the system.

07. **yum check-update**

Checks for available updates without actually installing them.

08. **yum clean all**

Clears all cached package data, headers, and metadata from disk.

09. **yum history**

Shows a history of all YUM transactions performed on the system.

10. **yum deplist <package>**

Displays the full dependency list for the specified package.

Note: Commands marked with <package> or <keyword> require substituting an actual package name or search term. Root or sudo privileges are typically required for install, remove, and update operations.